

Ghana

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** March 6, 1957 **Usage:** National

Ghana was the first country to use the pan-African colors of red, yellow, green, and black



Red recalls the blood shed by freedom fighters

Yellow represents mineral wealth

Green is symbolic of the country's rich forests

The star of African freedom

Africa



Previously the Gold Coast, **Ghana** became independent from Britain in 1957. It took its new name from that of an historic African empire.

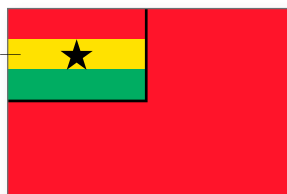
Kwame Nkrumah, Ghana's first leader after independence, was the first to introduce the politically symbolic pan-African colors—red, yellow, green, and black—into African flags. They were ultimately derived from the colors of Ethiopia, dating back to the 19th century and have now become associated with the Rastafarian movement in the West Indies. The flag also became

the inspiration for numerous other African flags during the period of decolonization.

Ghana followed the flag patterns established in the United Kingdom, and so has a both a red ensign for use on civil vessels and a white ensign for naval vessels. This use of several flags sets it apart from other West African states, which normally have only one all-purpose flag.

GHANAIAN RED ENSIGN

The national flag is placed in the canton



The field is in the style of the British Red Ensign